MSc Group 2 Project

ClearCare

Week 7 update · 23–29 Oct 2026

A record of

What inspectors found.
What the provider promised.
Whether the next inspection **found it fixed.**

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Phase 1 – User Evaluations (1)

Participants

30–60

approximate age range

What they liked

- Good start of a website
- Straightforward
- **Easier to Read mode**
- Easy navigation
- Informative content
- Complete details on Fair Deal
- HIQA reports
- Statistics

Phase 1 – User Evaluations (2)

What they didn't like

Although informative and helpful, it can be **overwhelming and cluttered**

A lot of text

Scrolling

Clinical feeling

User Journey

The step where the HSE checks your money seems scary to see and hear.

Dev note: step 4 of /how-a-family-chooses

Phase 1 – User Evaluations (3)

Suggestions and comments

> “Add a way to check the staff at a nursing home: whether nurses and carers are qualified and able to care for older people, for example by pulling in reviews or qualifications. Nothing like this exists in Ireland, so families have no way to be sure their relative is in good hands. This would give them that reassurance.”

1st Participant

Also suggested

- FAQ
- Comparison of homes
- Practical checklist for families visiting a nursing homes
- Transparency in last updated

Searching Inconsistencies

Google search

A general search shows nursing homes under both “Older Person’s” and “Disability” care centres, as labelled by HIQA.

ClearCare

Covers only the centres labelled “Older Person’s”.

- Disability centres are out of the project scope
- **Must be noted** in the project description and on the website

Comparison · fairpath.ie

ClearCare vs FairPath

ClearCare	FairPath
User centred	Functional website
Free summarization of reports	Fair Deal calculator
Shortlist and compare homes	**Selling Care Reports**

Legal · reuse of HIQA reports

Legalities

Public source	HIQA allows free reuse of its reports under the PSI licence (CC BY 4.0). We credit HIQA, link every original report, and make no claim of endorsement.
Copyright	Irish law allows text and data mining (Copyright Act 2000, s.53A for research and s.53B for commercial use). **HIQA has not opted out.**
Extraction, not generation	The LLM only extracts facts out of the report (care types, rooms, amenities).
EU AI Act, Art. 50	The labelling duty covers AI that generates text for the public. Extracted facts fall outside it, and we label them “found in the HIQA report by an AI tool” anyway.
Safeguards	Every value comes with an exact quote from the report and is checked against the report text, or dropped. The model can’t output “absent”. If a report doesn’t mention something, we say so rather than claiming the home lacks it.
Measured accuracy	A hand-labelled gold set gives precision, recall and F1 for each field.
Privacy	Reports are processed by OpenAI (US). A privacy notice on the site covers this, and the sign-in uses an encrypted cookie.

Legal · personal data

GDPR

Personal data	The names and roles of people who run homes, from HIQA reports; email addresses once accounts open. **Residents are never named.**
Legal basis	Legitimate interests: the reports are already published by a public regulator, staff are named in their professional role, and ClearCare is free and not for profit.
Data minimisation	Persons in charge and management contacts are left out when importing HIQA's register. AI services receive report text only, never user data.
Where data lives	The site, database and accounts are on AWS in the EU (Stockholm). AI services in the US read reports, protected by EU transfer safeguards.
Transparency	A privacy notice covers what we hold, why, who processes it, how long we keep it, and people's rights (Arts. 13 and 14).
People's rights	To see, correct, delete or object; anyone named in a report can object; complaints go to the Data Protection Commission.
Security	An encrypted, HTTP-only session cookie; no tracking or analytics cookies.

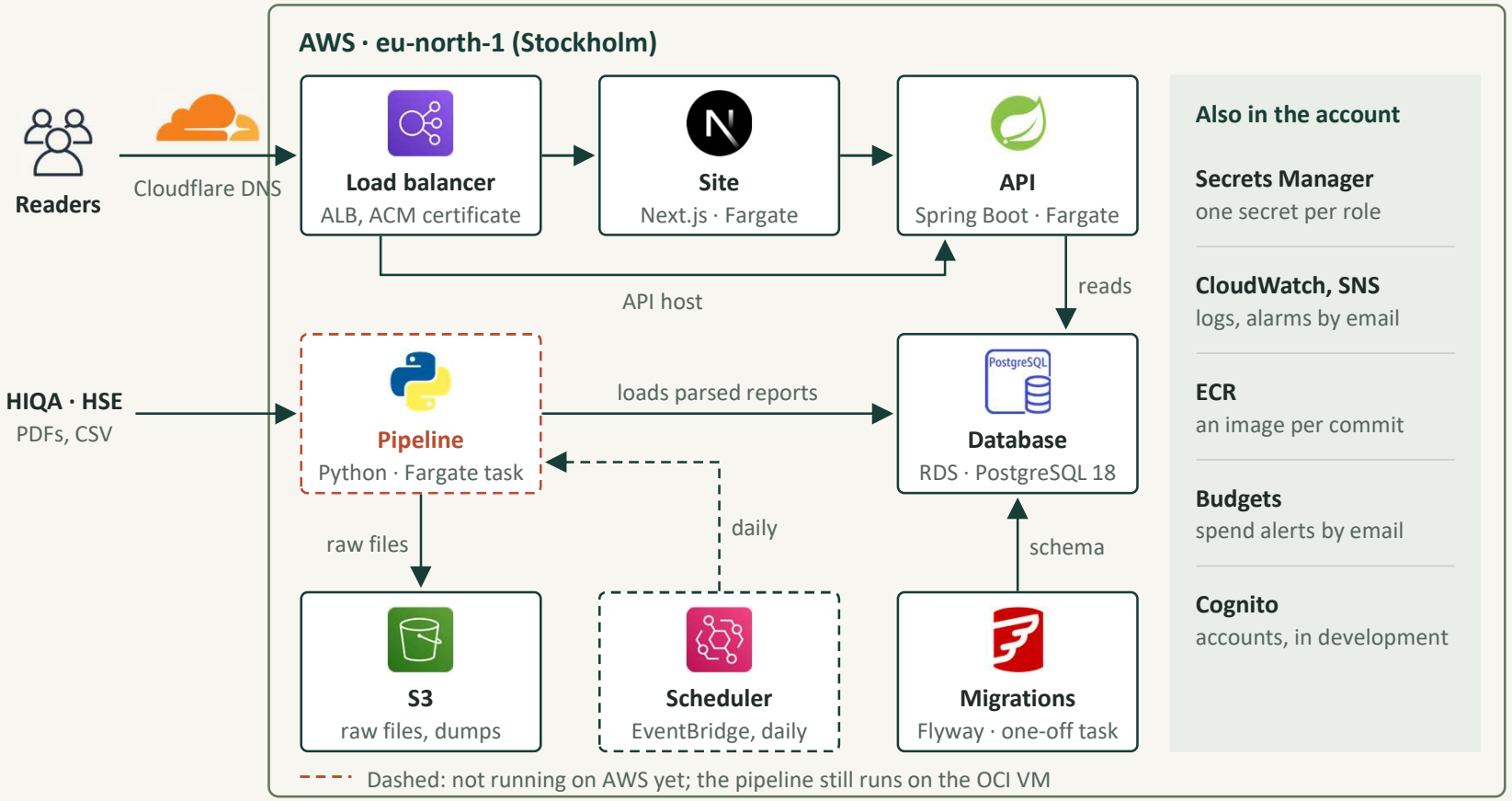
Legal · on the site

How ClearCare Enforces the Legalities

Beside the search filters	“Details found in each home’s latest HIQA report by an AI tool. It can miss things: a home shown may still offer what you’re looking for, so ask the home.”
On each amenity	The HIQA report it came from, the inspection date, and a link to the original PDF.
“Not mentioned” ≠ “not offered”	We never show a home as lacking something. A report that doesn’t mention it shows as **“not mentioned in the report”**.
Footer credit	“Contains Irish public sector information from HIQA, used under CC BY 4.0. Restructured by ClearCare. Not affiliated with or endorsed by HIQA.”
About our data page	Recommended: how the AI extraction works, its accuracy, and how to report a mistake.
Privacy notice	That reports are processed by OpenAI (US), what accounts store, and how long we keep it.
Original report	Always linked. ClearCare helps families find information; it doesn’t replace HIQA.

System architecture · on AWS since 27 Oct

System Architecture



Also in the account

Secrets Manager
one secret per role

CloudWatch, SNS
logs, alarms by email

ECR
an image per commit

Budgets
spend alerts by email

Cognito
accounts, in development

Outside AWS

GitHub Actions
builds images, deploys

Vercel
previews of pull requests

OCI VM
the pipeline and raw files for now; kept as rollback

System Architecture (2)

Cloud services	API and database run on AWS managed services, declared in Terraform. Before: one VM with Docker Compose.
Across clouds	Readers reach one region, eu-north-1. Outside AWS: Cloudflare DNS, Vercel previews
Cores and Spring Boot	The old VM had 4 cores, shared with another project; CPU peaked at 70% in the weekly ingest. Spring Boot answered in 80–140 ms. **On AWS: home page 0.2 s.**
Flyway	The pipeline writes and the API only reads, so neither owns the schema. Each change is one reviewed SQL file that Flyway applies before a deploy.

User accounts, end-to-end: what works today and what's left

Sign-Up and Sign-In	Creating and signing in. Hand off the visitor to a managed identity service (Cognito), so no page of ours ever asks for a password. Accounts stay optional: pages still works signed out.
Sign out	Log out ends our session and the hosted one, so the next person on that browser is not signed in as the last one.
Two environments	Development env for internal use. Production environment for live website.
Privacy and support	Privacy notice and a written process for deleting an account on request, and the signals we watch for sign-up abuse.
Where it stands	Turning production on for the live website. A branded login/sign-up page of our own.

Next Steps

Geocoding	Locate each home from its registered address.
Amenities and Care Types	Finalise the extraction.
User Accounts	Production readiness.
Public Release	With phase 2 of the user evaluation involving surveys.
Research Questions	Start on predictive modelling and on ontology.